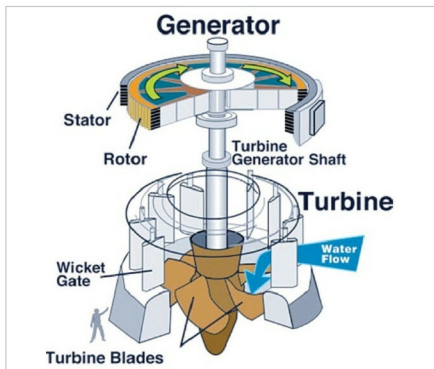




Turbine to generate hydropower (Image source: <https://water.usgs.gov/edu>)

TABLE I
INDIA'S HYDROELECTRIC
POWER GENERATION
CAPACITY

Basin/Rivers Probable	Installed capacity (MW)
Indus Basin	33,832
Ganga Basin	20,711
Central Indian River system	4152
Western flowing rivers of southern India	9430
Eastern flowing rivers of southern India	14,511
Brahmaputra Basin	66,065
Total	148,701

burn fossil fuels such as coal, it does not cause air pollution.

2. Each region with access to a river or any other water body with flowing water is capable of generating its own hydroelectric power.

3. Among all the renewable sources of energy, hydroelectric power makes up for the most cost-effective and reliable power resource. It is recognised and harnessed the most across the world, since the main source of water cycle is sun, which is indestructible.

4. In the process of creating hydroelectricity, normally in dams, reservoirs are created. These reservoirs are often used for commercial activities like fishing and boating.

5. Using the power of turbines, hydropower plants can produce zero to maximum energy output in very less time. Hydroelectric power is therefore used as power backup in disruptions and during emergencies.

6. Manual control over an otherwise naturally free water body like a river can be utilised to solve various problems like water supply, irrigation and flood control as well.

Indian scenario and opportunities

India is one of the major hydroelectric power producers in the Asian region and the seventh largest in the world. As of April 2017, the country's installed capacity of hydropower generation was around 44,594MW with additional 4280MW from smaller units. The National Hydroelectric Power Corporation (NHPC), Northeast Electric Power Company (NEEPCO), Sutlej Jal Vidyut Nigam (SJVN), THDC and NTPC Hydro are government bodies responsible for hydro-

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